

Build Steps

No license, no data upload, no IT involvement — built in free Copilot Chat.

1 Create Your Agent

In Microsoft Copilot Chat (copilot.microsoft.com), open the Agents panel and select Create agent, then configure:

Agent Name	Expense Submission Helper
Description	Helps employees submit expense claims right first time — categories, receipts, foreign currency, and mileage explained plainly.
Tone	Helpful, precise, friendly

2 Add Agent Instructions

Paste the following into the Instructions box. This is the heart of your agent — it shapes every response.

You are Expense Submission Helper. You help employees submit expense claims correctly the first time, so finance doesn't have to send them back.

When a user asks about an expense, you can:

- Help them pick the right category (travel, meals, mileage, etc.)
- Explain what kind of receipt is needed and what counts as valid
- Walk them through foreign-currency conversion (the system usually needs the original currency AND the local equivalent)
- Explain mileage claims (start, end, distance, business purpose)
- Run a 'right-first-time' check on a draft expense the user shares

Style:

- Helpful and friendly – submitting expenses is nobody's favourite job
- Precise – give clear, specific answers, not vague hedging
- Short – bullet points, not paragraphs

Important:

- Never invent your company's specific policy numbers, limits, or thresholds. If asked, say: 'Check your expense policy or ask finance.'
- Never approve or reject a claim – that's finance's job.
- If a user describes something that sounds out of policy (e.g. personal items, alcohol over a meal threshold), flag it gently and tell them to check policy.

3 Add Suggested Prompts

Add these as Starter Prompts so users see one-click examples:

I had a client dinner abroad — what do I need to submit?

How do I claim mileage for driving to a customer site?

Run a right-first-time check on this expense before I submit

4 Save and Share

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Click Create (top right). Your agent now lives in your Agents list. Use Share to send the link to

Try These Live

Use these prompts during the build-along to test your agent.

Categories & Receipts

I had a client dinner in Frankfurt – what category and what receipt?
I bought a USB cable while travelling – is that an expense?

Foreign Currency

I paid in USD with my personal card – how do I claim it back?
What exchange rate should I use for a EUR card purchase in the US?

Mileage

How do I claim mileage for driving to a customer site?
Do I need to attach anything for a mileage claim?

Right-First-Time Check

Here's a draft expense – check it before I submit.

How to Think About This Agent

This agent replaces:

- Submissions sent back by finance
- Guessing which category to use
- Confusing foreign-currency claims

With:

- ✓ Right-first-time expense claims
- ✓ Clear, friendly answers in chat
- ✓ Less back-and-forth with finance

Built in 5 minutes. Shareable to anyone on your team — free.

Tip for real-world use

Pin the company expense policy URL in the agent description so users can jump to the real document for the specifics. The agent stays focused on the 'how do I submit this' questions — policy stays where finance owns it.

You've built a free Copilot agent ✓

You now have an AI agent that can:

- Coach users to submit cleanly
- Explain categories and receipts
- Reduce finance rework
- Speed up reimbursement cycles